Daniel 7 & 8: The Kingdoms Revealed

A Complete Bible Study Guide

The Same Kingdoms from a Different Perspective

> **How this guide uses Daniel 7 and Daniel 8 together**: **Daniel 7** is the primary prophetic vision studied here — the four beasts, the little horn, and the heavenly judgment. **Daniel 8** is used as a *direct biblical identifier* within this guide: God Himself names Medo-Persia (Daniel 8:20) and Greece (Daniel 8:21-22), confirming the identity of the bear and the leopard with certainty. This is the Bible interpreting itself. Daniel 8 also introduces the 2,300-day prophecy and expands on the little horn — those elements are studied in the companion guide on Daniel 8.

Introduction: Why Three Prophecies About the Same Kingdoms?

God did not give Daniel just one prophecy about world history — He gave **three overlapping prophecies**, each adding layers of detail:

	Daniel 2	Daniel 7	Daniel 8
Seen by	Nebuchadnezzar (pagan king)	Daniel (God's prophet)	Daniel (God's prophet)
Symbols	Metallic image	Four beasts	Ram and goat
Kingdoms	Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, Rome	Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, Rome	Medo-Persia and Greece (named directly)
Focus	The succession of empires	The little horn and heavenly judgment	The little horn's activities in greater detail
Perspective	Human glory	God's view of kingdoms	God's sanctuary and the 2,300 days
Identifies	What	Who (beasts)	**Names them directly** (Daniel 8:20-21)

This guide focuses on Daniel 7 as the primary text, and uses Daniel 8 as a biblical cross-reference — because God Himself names Medo-Persia (Daniel 8:20) and Greece (Daniel 8:21) by name, removing all guesswork about the bear and the leopard.

Two perspectives on the same kingdoms:

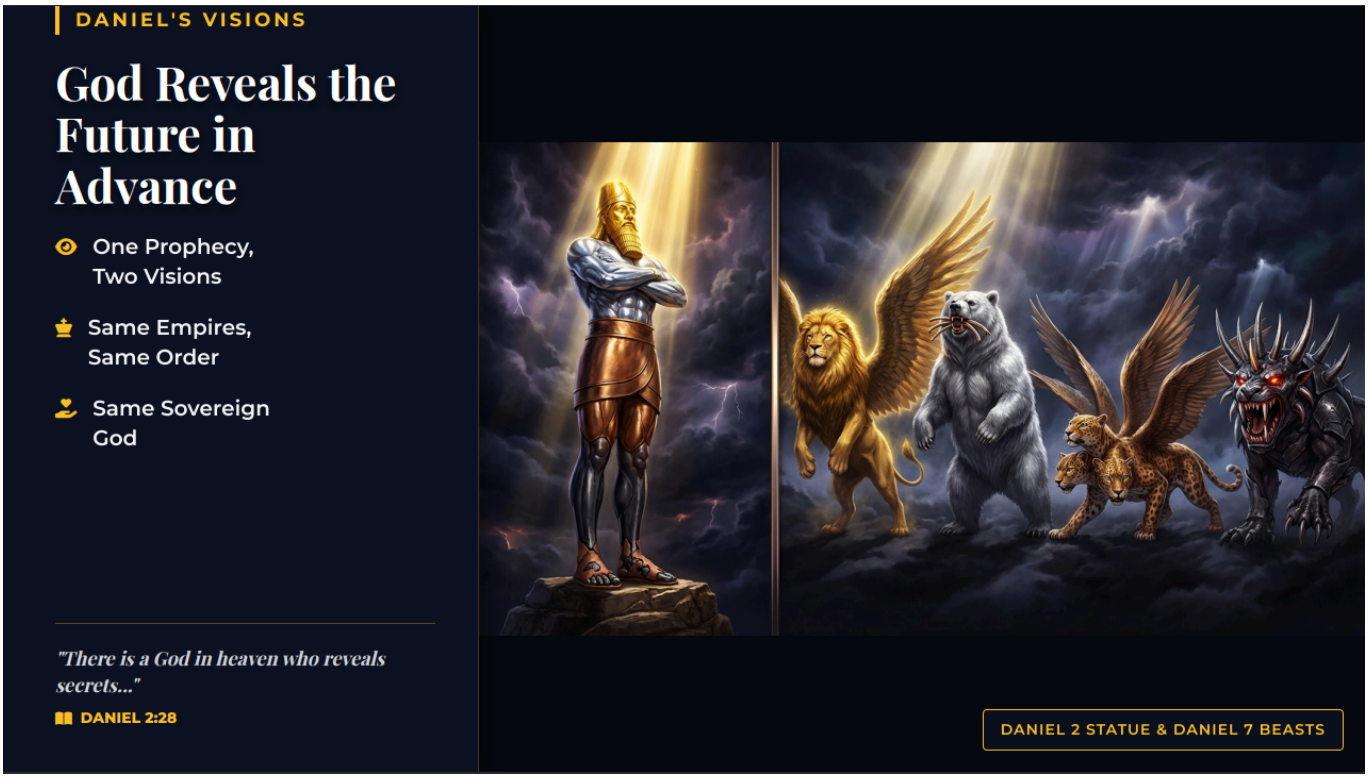
1. **Human perspective** (Daniel 2): Kingdoms appear magnificent, powerful, glorious — precious metals
2. **God's perspective** (Daniel 7): Kingdoms are brutal, beastly, oppressive — savage animals

Why study all three together?

1. **Confirms the interpretation** — When three independent prophecies describe the same kingdoms, we know the interpretation is correct

2. **Adds crucial details** — Daniel 7 reveals the **little horn power** (not detailed in Daniel 2) that persecutes God's people; Daniel 8 names them and gives the 2,300-day timeline
3. **Shows God's viewpoint** — What humans admire, God despises; what humans glorify, God judges
4. **Reveals the judgment** — Daniel 7 shows the **heavenly courtroom** where God judges these beast kingdoms

Key Principle: We will again use **only the Bible** to interpret this prophecy. Scripture will interpret Scripture. No human wisdom—just God's Word.



God Reveals the Future in Advance

Part 1: The Setting - Daniel's Vision (553 BCE)

When and Where Did This Vision Occur?

> **Daniel 7:1** - "In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon Daniel had a dream and visions of his head upon his bed: then he wrote the dream, and told the sum of the matters."

Historical Context:

- **Date**: First year of Belshazzar = approximately **553 BCE**
- **Timeline**: About **50 years after** Nebuchadnezzar's dream in Daniel 2 (603 BCE)
- **Location**: Babylon (still the dominant world power)
- **Who**: Daniel himself receives the vision (not interpreting someone else's dream this time)

Important Note: Daniel 7 occurred **before** Daniel 5 (Belshazzar's feast) and **before** Daniel 6 (Daniel in the lion's den). The chapters are arranged **thematically**, not chronologically.

Why Belshazzar?

Belshazzar was co-regent with his father Nabonidus. While Nabonidus was away campaigning, Belshazzar ruled Babylon. He was the **last king** before Babylon fell to Medo-Persia in 539 BCE (just 14 years after this vision).

Significance: God gave Daniel this vision while Babylon was still in power, showing that the first beast (lion) represented Babylon—confirming the interpretation before it even fell.

Daniel's Response: He Wrote It Down

> **Daniel 7:1b** - "...then he wrote the dream, and told the sum of the matters."

Why this matters:

- Daniel **documented** the vision immediately
- He recorded "the sum of the matters" = main points, essential details
- This written record preserved God's prophecy for **over 2,500 years**
- We can read the exact same words Daniel wrote in 553 BCE

Application: When God reveals truth, write it down. Don't trust memory alone. Preserve what God shows you.

Part 2: The Vision - Four Beasts from the Sea

The Great Sea and Four Winds

> **Daniel 7:2** - "Daniel spake and said, I saw in my vision by night, and, behold, the four winds of the heaven strove upon the great sea."

Key Symbols:

1. **The great sea** = ?
2. **Four winds strove** = ?

Method: Let the Bible interpret itself. Where else does Scripture use these symbols?

Biblical Definition: Waters/Sea = Peoples, Nations

> **Revelation 17:15** - "And he saith unto me, The waters which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues."

Clear definition: **Waters = peoples, multitudes, nations, tongues**

Additional confirmation:

> **Isaiah 57:20** - "But the wicked are like the troubled sea, when it cannot rest, whose waters cast up mire and dirt."

> **Isaiah 17:12-13** - "Woe to the multitude of many people, which make a noise like the noise of the seas; and to the rushing of nations, that make a rushing like the rushing of mighty waters! The nations shall rush like the rushing of many waters: but God shall rebuke them, and they shall flee far off, and

> shall be chased as the chaff of the mountains before the wind, and like a rolling thing before the whirlwind."

Pattern confirmed:

- Seas/waters = peoples and nations
- Troubled sea = wicked, unstable nations
- Rushing waters = warring, conquering nations

Application to Daniel 7:2: The "great sea" represents the **populated areas of the earth**—the masses of humanity from which kingdoms arise.

Biblical Definition: Four Winds = War, Strife, Conquest

> **Jeremiah 49:36-37** - "And upon Elam will I bring the four winds from the four quarters of heaven, and will scatter them toward all those winds; and there shall be no nation whither the outcasts of Elam shall not come. For I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies, and before them that seek their life: and I will bring evil upon them, even My fierce anger, saith the LORD; and I will send the sword after them, till I have consumed them"

Key phrases:

- "Four winds from the four quarters of heaven" = universal conflict
- "I will send the sword after them" = war, military conquest
- "Till I have consumed them" = complete destruction

The four winds represent warfare and conquest coming from all directions (north, south, east, west).

Additional confirmation from Zechariah:

> **Zechariah 7:14** - "But I scattered them with a whirlwind among all the nations whom they knew not. Thus the land was desolate after them, that no man passed through nor returned: for they laid the pleasant land desolate."

The wind/whirlwind = God's instrument of scattering and judgment through conquest—confirmed across multiple prophetic books.

> **Jeremiah 4:5-7** - "Declare ye in Judah, and publish in Jerusalem; and say, Blow ye the trumpet in the land: cry, gather together, and say, Assemble yourselves, and let us go into the defensed cities. Set up the standard toward Zion: retire, stay not: for I will bring evil from the north, and a great destruction. The lion is come up from his thicket, and the destroyer of the Gentiles is on his way; he is gone forth from his place to make thy land desolate; and thy cities shall be laid waste, without an inhabitant."

Key imagery:

- "Evil from the north" = invading army (Babylon came from the north)
- **"The lion is come up"** = Babylon described as a lion
- "Destroyer of the Gentiles" = military conquest

Application to Daniel 7:2: The "four winds strove upon the great sea" means **warfare and conquest arise from among the nations**. The four beasts rise through military conflict.

The Vision: Four Great Beasts

> **Daniel 7:3** - "And four great beasts came up from the sea, diverse one from another."

What we know so far:

- **Sea** = peoples, nations, populated earth
- **Four winds striving** = warfare, conquest, conflict
- **Four beasts** = Four kingdoms arising through conquest

Key word: "diverse" = Each beast different from the others, representing distinct empires with unique characteristics.

Connection to Daniel 2: Remember the four metals (gold, silver, bronze, iron)? These **four beasts** represent the **same four kingdoms**—just from God's perspective instead of man's.

Part 3: Beast #1 - The Lion (Babylon)

Description of the First Beast

> **Daniel 7:4** - "The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings: I beheld till the wings thereof were plucked, and it was lifted up from the earth, and made stand upon the feet as a man, and a man's heart was given to it."

The Lion's Characteristics:

1. **Like a lion** - King of beasts, fierce, powerful
2. **Eagle's wings** - Swift conquest, speed, majesty
3. **Wings plucked** - Loss of power, conquest slowed
4. **Made to stand as a man** - Humanized, weakened
5. **Man's heart given** - Lost its fierce, conquering nature

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Biblical Identification: Lion = Babylon

How do we know the lion represents Babylon? **The Bible tells us directly**.

> **Jeremiah 4:7** - "The lion is come up from his thicket, and the destroyer of the Gentiles is on his way; he is gone forth from his place to make thy land desolate; and thy cities shall be laid waste, without an inhabitant."

Context: This is Jeremiah's prophecy about **Babylon** invading Judah. God calls Babylon "the lion."

> **Jeremiah 50:17** - "Israel is a scattered sheep; the lions have driven him away: first the king of Assyria hath devoured him; and last this Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon hath broken his bones."

Direct identification:

- Israel = scattered sheep
- **Lions** = Assyria and **Babylon** (Nebuchadnezzar specifically named)

Confirmed: The lion = Babylon under Nebuchadnezzar.

The Eagle's Wings: Swift Conquest

> **Jeremiah 4:13** - "Behold, he shall come up as clouds, and his chariots shall be as a whirlwind: his horses are swifter than eagles. Woe unto us! for we are spoiled."

Description of Babylon's military:

- "Swift as eagles" = rapid conquest
- "Chariots as a whirlwind" = overwhelming force
- "Come up as clouds" = massive army

> **Deuteronomy 28:49** - "The LORD will bring a nation against you from afar, from the end of the earth, as swift as the eagle flies, a nation whose language you will not understand"

Prophecy of invading nation: Described as swift as an eagle (fulfilled by Babylon).

Why horses/chariots symbolize military power:

> **Deuteronomy 20:1** - "When thou goest out to battle against thine enemies, and seest horses, and chariots..."

> **Revelation 19:11** - "And I saw heaven opened, and behold a white horse; and He that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he doth judge and make war."

Horses and chariots = military might, warfare, conquest

Application: The **lion with eagle's wings** perfectly describes Babylon's swift, powerful military conquests under Nebuchadnezzar.

Wings Plucked: Babylon's Decline

> **Daniel 7:4b** - "...the wings thereof were plucked, and it was lifted up from the earth, and made stand upon the feet as a man, and a man's heart was given to it."

What happened?

After Nebuchadnezzar's pride led to his humiliation (Daniel 4), Babylon **lost its conquering nature**:

1. **Wings plucked** = No more rapid expansion
2. **Made to stand as a man** = Became weak, human, vulnerable
3. **Man's heart given** = Lost its fierce, lion-like nature

Historical fulfillment:

- Nebuchadnezzar's successors were weak kings
- Babylon stopped expanding militarily
- By Belshazzar's reign (Daniel 5), Babylon was corrupt, decadent, ready to fall
- In 539 BCE, Medo-Persia conquered Babylon **without a fight** (Cyrus diverted the Euphrates and entered through the riverbed)

The fierce lion had become a weak man.

Confirmation: Lion = Babylon (Same as Gold Head)

Daniel 2 identification:

> **Daniel 2:38** - "Thou [Nebuchadnezzar, Babylon] art this head of gold."

Daniel 7 identification:

> **Daniel 7:4** - "The first was like a lion..." (clearly Babylon based on Jeremiah's prophecies)

Both prophecies agree: **First kingdom = Babylon**

Dates: 605-539 BCE (exactly as in Daniel 2)

The Kingdom of Babylon - The Head of Gold (605-539 BCE)

Part 4: Beast #2 - The Bear (Medo-Persia)

Description of the Second Beast

> **Daniel 7:5** - "And behold another beast, a second, like to a bear, and it raised up itself on one side, and it had three ribs in the mouth of it between the teeth of it: and they said thus unto it, Arise, devour much flesh."

The Bear's Characteristics:

1. **Like a bear** - Powerful, crushing, brutal
2. **Raised up on one side** - Lopsided, one part stronger than the other
3. **Three ribs in its mouth** - Three conquered territories
4. **"Arise, devour much flesh"** - Command to conquer more

Biblical Identification: Bear = Medo-Persia

How do we know? **Daniel 8 directly identifies this kingdom.**

> **Daniel 8:3-4** - "Then I lifted up mine eyes, and saw, and, behold, there stood before the river a ram which had two horns: and the two horns were high; but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last. I saw the ram pushing westward, and northward, and southward; so that no beasts might stand before him, neither was there any that could deliver out of his hand; but he did according to his will, and became great."

Key details:

- **Ram with two horns** = Two-part kingdom
- **One horn higher than the other** = One part more powerful
- **Higher came up last** = The stronger part rose second
- **Pushing west, north, south** = Three-directional conquest

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> **Daniel 8:20** - "The ram which thou sawest having two horns are the kings of Media and Persia."

God Himself identifies the ram = Media and Persia (Medo-Persia)

Connection to Daniel 7:5:

- **"Raised up on one side"** = One horn higher = **Persia was stronger than Media**
- The Medes conquered Babylon first, but the Persians (under Cyrus) became dominant
- **"One horn higher, came up last"** = Persia rose to power after Media, became the dominant part

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The Three Ribs: Three Major Conquests

> **Daniel 7:5b** - "...it had three ribs in the mouth of it between the teeth of it..."

> **Daniel 8:4** - "I saw the ram pushing westward, and northward, and southward..."

The three ribs represent the three major kingdoms Medo-Persia conquered:

1. **Lydia** (West) - Conquered by Cyrus in 547 BCE
    - Located in western Asia Minor (modern Turkey)
    - Wealthy kingdom famous for gold (King Croesus)

2. **Babylon** (North) - Conquered by Cyrus in 539 BCE
    - The previous world empire
    - Conquered when Cyrus diverted the Euphrates River
3. **Egypt** (South) - Conquered by Cambyses II (Cyrus's son) in 525 BCE
    - Ancient civilization, long-standing power
    - Last major independent kingdom in the region

The "three ribs" = Lydia, Babylon, Egypt—the three great powers Medo-Persia crushed.

"Arise, Devour Much Flesh"

> **Daniel 7:5c** - "...and they said thus unto it, Arise, devour much flesh."

Who said this? God, through His providence, decreed Medo-Persia would conquer extensively.

Historical fulfillment: Medo-Persia became the **largest empire up to that time**:

- Stretched from India to Ethiopia
- Controlled 127 provinces (Esther 1:1)
- Ruled over millions of people
- "Devoured much flesh" = conquered and absorbed many nations

The bear represents brute strength—not the swift elegance of the lion/eagle (Babylon), but crushing, overwhelming force.

Confirmation: Bear = Medo-Persia (Same as Silver Chest)

Daniel 2 identification:

> **Daniel 2:39a** - "And after thee shall arise another kingdom inferior to thee..." **Daniel 5:28** - "PERES; Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians."

Daniel 7 identification:

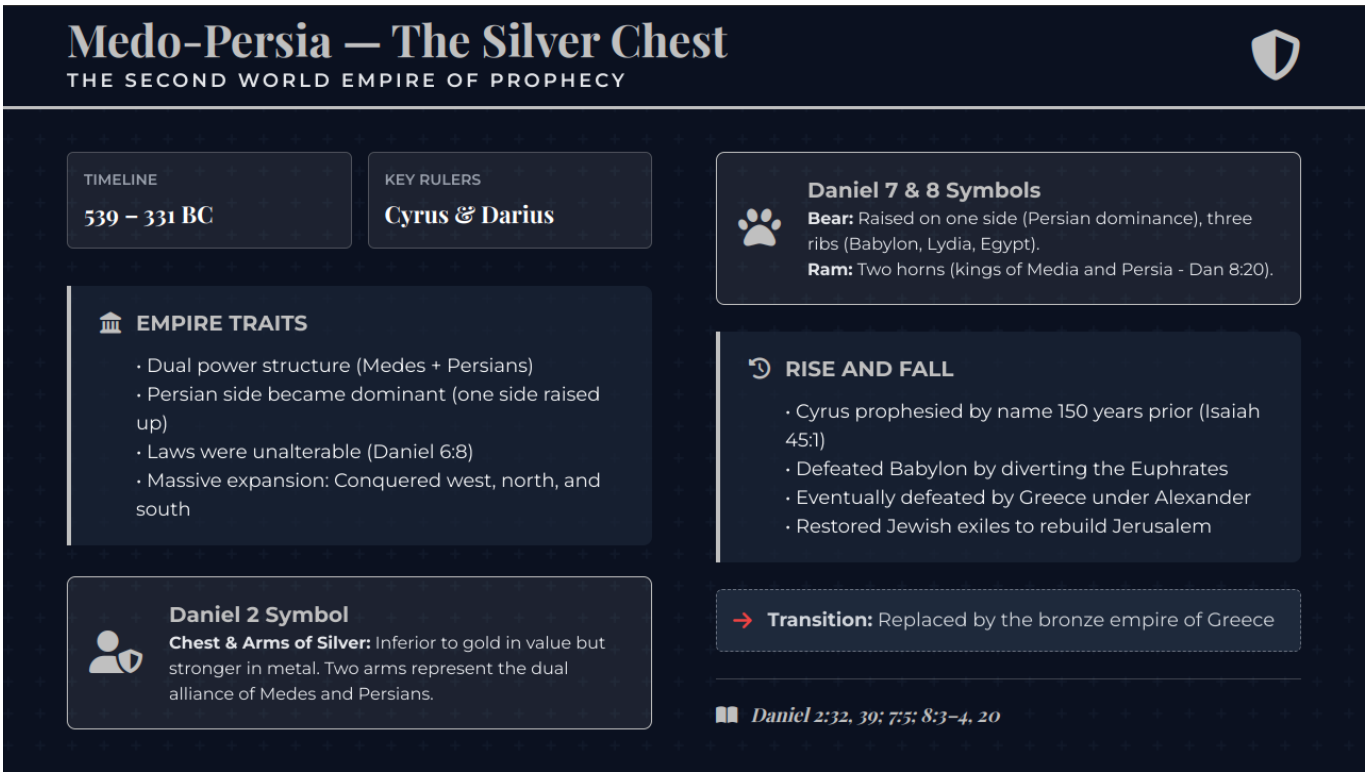
> **Daniel 7:5** - "And behold another beast, a second, like to a bear..."

Daniel 8 identification:

> **Daniel 8:20** - "The ram which thou sawest having two horns are the kings of Media and Persia."

All three prophecies agree: **Second kingdom = Medo-Persia**

Dates: 539-331 BCE (exactly as in Daniel 2)



The Kingdom of Medo-Persia - The Bear raised on one side with 3 Ribs in mouth (539-331 BCE)

Part 5: Beast #3 - The Leopard (Greece)

Description of the Third Beast

> **Daniel 7:6** - "After this I beheld, and lo another, like a leopard, which had upon the back of it four wings of a fowl; the beast had also four heads; and dominion was given to it."

The Leopard's Characteristics:

1. **Like a leopard** - Swift, agile, cunning predator
2. **Four wings of a fowl** - Even faster than the eagle-winged lion (double the wings!)
3. **Four heads** - Four-part division
4. **Dominion was given to it** - Conquered by divine appointment

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Biblical Identification: Leopard = Greece

How do we know? **Daniel 8 directly identifies this kingdom.**

> **Daniel 8:5-8** - "And as I was considering, behold, an he goat came from the west on the face of the whole earth, and touched not the ground: and the goat had a notable horn between his eyes. And he came to the ram that had two horns, which I had seen standing before the river, and ran unto him in the fury of his power. And I saw him come close unto the ram, and he was moved with choler against him, and smote the ram, and brake his two horns: and there was no power in the ram to stand before him, but he cast him down to the ground, and stamped upon him: and there was none that could deliver the ram out of his hand. Therefore the he goat waxed very great: and when he was strong, the great horn was broken; and for it came up four notable ones toward the four winds of heaven."

Key details:

- **He goat came from the west** = Greece (west of Medo-Persia)
- **Touched not the ground** = Incredible speed of conquest
- **Notable horn between his eyes** = One great king
- **Smote the ram** = Defeated Medo-Persia
- **Great horn was broken** = The great king died
- **Four notable ones came up** = Kingdom divided four ways

> **Daniel 8:21-22** - "And the rough goat is the king of Grecia: and the great horn that is between his eyes is the first king. Now that being broken, whereas four stood up for it, four kingdoms shall stand up out of the nation, but not in his power."

God Himself identifies:

- **Goat = Greece** (Grecia)
- **Great horn = the first king** = Alexander the Great
- **Four kingdoms stood up** = Division after Alexander's death

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The Four Wings: Unmatched Speed of Conquest

> **Daniel 7:6a** - "...like a leopard, which had upon the back of it four wings of a fowl..."

Why four wings?

Comparison:

- Babylon (lion) = **two wings** (eagle's wings = two) = swift conquest
- Greece (leopard) = **four wings** = **twice as fast** = conquered world in just **13 years**!

The key point: An eagle has two wings. The leopard had *double* that—four wings on an already fast animal emphasize extraordinary speed. Greece under Alexander moved faster than any empire before it.

Historical fact: **Alexander the Great** (336-323 BCE) conquered the known world faster than any conqueror before or since:

Timeline of Alexander's Conquests:

- **334 BCE** - Invaded Persia, won Battle of Granicus
- **333 BCE** - Won Battle of Issus, defeated Persian King Darius III
- **332 BCE** - Conquered Egypt, founded Alexandria
- **331 BCE** - Won Battle of Gaugamela, destroyed Persian Empire
- **330 BCE** - Captured Persian capital Persepolis
- **327 BCE** - Reached India
- **323 BCE** - Died in Babylon at age 32

In just 13 years (ages 20-32), Alexander conquered:

- Greece
- Asia Minor (Turkey)
- Syria
- Egypt

- Entire Persian Empire
- Parts of India

"Touched not the ground" (Daniel 8:5) = moved so fast his feet barely touched earth—perfect description of Alexander's lightning campaigns.

The four wings represent unmatched speed.

The Four Heads: Division After Alexander's Death

> **Daniel 7:6b** - "...the beast had also four heads..."

> **Daniel 8:8** - "Therefore the he goat waxed very great: and when he was strong, the great horn was broken; and for it came up four notable ones toward the four winds of heaven."

> **Daniel 8:22** - "Now that being broken, whereas four stood up for it, four kingdoms shall stand up out of the nation, but not in his power."

Historical fulfillment:

When Alexander died suddenly in 323 BCE (age 32), his empire was divided among **four of his generals**:

1. **Cassander** - Took **Greece** and Macedonia
2. **Lysimachus** - Took **Asia Minor** (Turkey)
3. **Seleucus** - Took **Syria** and the eastern territories
4. **Ptolemy** - Took **Egypt**

"Four kingdoms... but not in his power" = None of Alexander's four successors had his strength or unified control. The empire was permanently divided.

The four heads perfectly fulfill the prophecy.

"Dominion Was Given To It"

> **Daniel 7:6c** - "...and dominion was given to it."

Key phrase: "**was given**" = passive voice = God gave Greece dominion over the world

This wasn't luck or mere military skill—it was divine appointment.

Historical evidence of divine providence:

When Alexander reached Jerusalem, he planned to destroy it for refusing to help him during his siege of Tyre. But something remarkable happened:

Alexander the Great's own testimony (recorded by Jewish historian Josephus):

> "I did not adore him, but that God who hath honored him with his high-priesthood. For I saw this very person in a dream, in this very habit, when I was at Dios in Macedonia, who, when I was considering with myself how I might obtain the dominion of Asia, exhorted me to make no delay, but boldly to pass over the sea thither, for that he would conduct my army and would give me the dominion over

> the Persians; whence it is that having seen no other in that habit, and now seeing this person in it, and remembering that vision, and the exhortation which I had in my dream, **I believe that I bring this army under the Divine conduct, and shall therewith conquer Darius, and destroy the Power of the Persians, and that all things will succeed according to what is in my mind.**" - Alexander the Great (Josephus, *Antiquities of the Jews*, book xi, chapter 8, par. 5)

Alexander admitted:

1. He had a dream from God
2. God told him to conquer Asia
3. God promised to give him dominion over the Persians
4. He believed he conquered **under Divine conduct**

Even pagan Alexander acknowledged God gave him dominion!

Confirmation: Leopard = Greece (Same as Bronze Belly)

Daniel 2 identification:

> **Daniel 2:39b** - "...and another third kingdom of bronze, which shall bear rule over all the earth."

Daniel 7 identification:

> **Daniel 7:6** - "After this I beheld, and lo another, like a leopard... and dominion was given to it."

Daniel 8 identification:

> **Daniel 8:21** - "And the rough goat is the king of Grecia..."

All three prophecies agree: **Third kingdom = Greece**

Dates: 331-168 BCE (exactly as in Daniel 2)

The Kingdom of Greece - The Leopard with 4 heads and 4 wings (331-168 BCE)

Part 6: Beast #4 - The Terrible Beast (Rome)

Description of the Fourth Beast

> **Daniel 7:7** - "After this I saw in the night visions, and behold a fourth beast, dreadful and terrible, and strong exceedingly; and it had great iron teeth: it devoured and brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with the feet of it: and it was diverse from all the beasts that were before it; and it had ten horns."

The Fourth Beast's Characteristics:

1. **Dreadful and terrible** - Inspires fear and horror
2. **Strong exceedingly** - Most powerful of all beasts
3. **Great iron teeth** - Crushes everything (note: IRON, matching Daniel 2!)
4. **Devoured and brake in pieces** - Total destruction of enemies
5. **Stamped the residue** - Whatever it didn't eat, it trampled
6. **Diverse from all the beasts** - Unlike any before it
7. **Had ten horns** - Divided into ten parts

Biblical Identification: The Terrible Beast = Rome

How do we know? Historical succession and biblical clues.

Connection to Daniel 2:

> **Daniel 2:40** - "And the fourth kingdom shall be strong as iron: forasmuch as iron breaketh in pieces and subdueth all things: and as iron that breaketh all these, shall it break in pieces and bruise."

Key word: **IRON**

> **Daniel 7:7** - "...and it had great iron teeth..."

Same word: **IRON**

Both prophecies describe the fourth kingdom with IRON:

- Daniel 2: Iron legs
- Daniel 7: Iron teeth

Confirmed: Fourth beast = Fourth kingdom = **Rome**

Why Rome Is "Diverse From All the Beasts"

> **Daniel 7:7b** - "...and it was diverse from all the beasts that were before it..."

How was Rome different?

1. Form of Government:

- Babylon = Absolute monarchy (one king rules all)
- Medo-Persia = Dual monarchy (Medes and Persians)
- Greece = Divided monarchy (four kingdoms)
- **Rome** = **Republic, then Empire** (Senate, consuls, then emperors—unique governmental system)

2. Legal System:

- Rome developed **Roman law**—foundation of modern Western legal systems
- Concept of citizenship, legal rights, contracts
- **Most influential legal system in human history**

3. Military Organization:

- Rome's **legions** were unmatched in discipline, training, and strategy
- Professional standing army (not just conscripts)
- Superior engineering (roads, siege weapons, fortifications)

4. Duration:

- Rome lasted longer than any previous empire:
  - Western Roman Empire: 168 BCE - 476 CE (644+ years)
  - Eastern Roman Empire (Byzantine): Continued until 1453 CE (1,621 years total!)

5. Cultural Impact:

- Latin language influenced all Romance languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Portuguese, Romanian)
- Roman architecture, art, literature shaped Western civilization
- Rome ruled during time of Christ—crucified Jesus under Roman authority

6. Religious Role:

- Rome transformed from pagan empire to vehicle for **papal power** (the little horn, which we'll study next)
- Only empire that continued through religious transformation

Rome was diverse—unlike anything before it.

The Ten Horns: Division of Rome

> **Daniel 7:7c** - "...and it had ten horns."

> **Daniel 7:24a** - "And the ten horns out of this kingdom are ten kings that shall arise..."

What do horns represent in prophecy?

In biblical prophecy, **horns = kings or kingdoms** (power, authority):

> **Daniel 7:24** - "And the ten horns out of this kingdom are **ten kings** that shall arise..." **Daniel 8:20** - "The ram which thou sawest having two horns are **the kings** of Media and Persia." **Revelation 17:12** - "And the ten horns which thou sawest are **ten kings**..."

Horns = kings/kingdoms throughout Scripture.

The Ten Divisions of Rome (476 CE)

When Western Rome fell in **476 CE**, it divided into **ten major Germanic tribes**:

The Ten Horns (Ten Germanic Tribes):

1. **Franks** → Modern **France**
2. **Anglo-Saxons** → Modern **England**
3. **Alemanni** → Modern **Germany**
4. **Suevi** → Modern **Portugal**
5. **Visigoths** → Modern **Spain**
6. **Lombards** → Modern **Italy**
7. **Burgundians** → Modern **Switzerland**
8. **Heruli** → **Destroyed 493 CE**
9. **Vandals** → **Destroyed 534 CE**
10. **Ostrogoths** → **Destroyed 538 CE**

Note: Three tribes (Heruli, Vandals, Ostrogoths) were destroyed. We'll see why in the next section (the little horn).

Seven remain as modern nations: France, England, Germany, Portugal, Spain, Italy, Switzerland

Exact fulfillment: Western Rome divided into exactly **ten** parts, just as prophesied.

Confirmation: Terrible Beast = Rome (Same as Iron Legs)

Daniel 2 identification:

> **Daniel 2:40** - "And the fourth kingdom shall be strong as iron..."

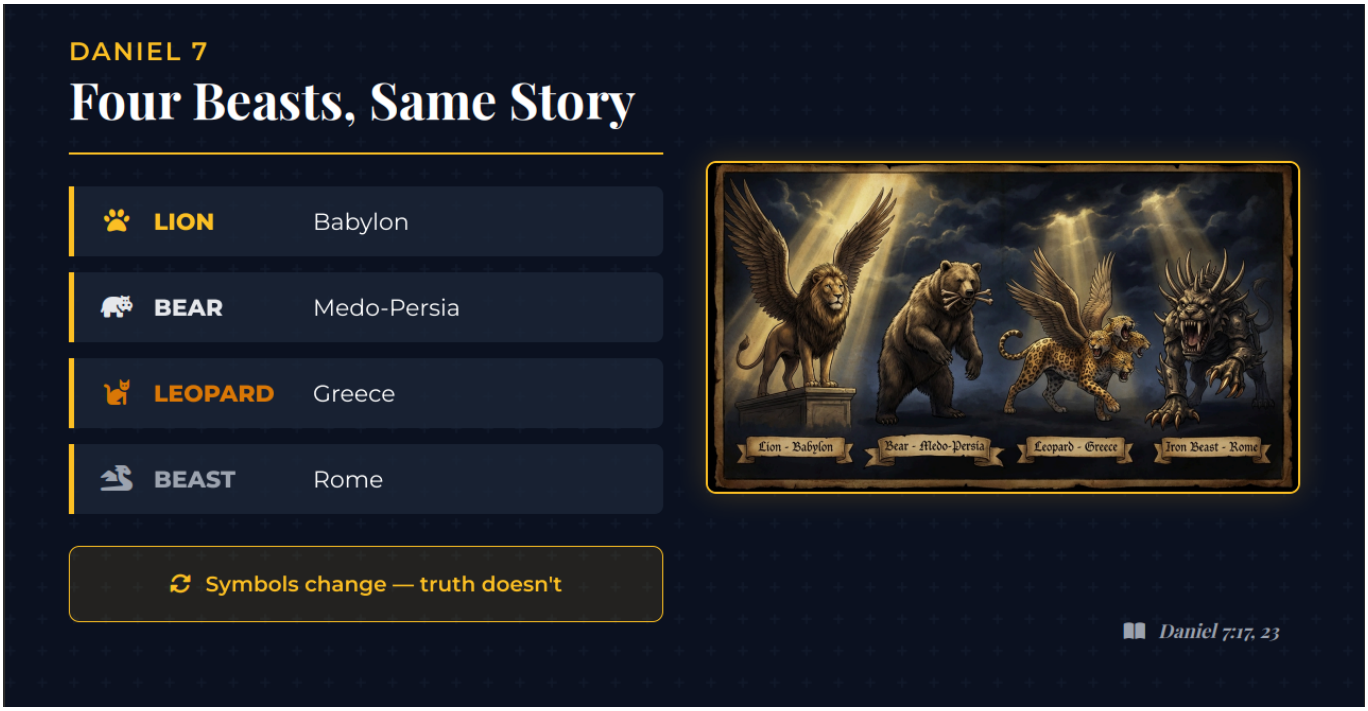
Daniel 7 identification:

> **Daniel 7:7** - "...a fourth beast... and it had great iron teeth..."

Both prophecies agree: **Fourth kingdom = Rome, characterized by iron strength**

Dates: 168 BCE (conquered Greece) - 476 CE (Western Rome fell; continued as Eastern Rome/Byzantine until 1453 CE)

The Kingdom of Rome - The Legs of Iron (168 BCE - 476 CE)



Four Beasts, Same Story

Part 7: The Little Horn - A New Power Emerges

Description of the Little Horn

> **Daniel 7:8** - "I considered the horns, and, behold, there came up among them another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots: and, behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man, and a mouth speaking great things."

The Little Horn's Characteristics:

1. **"Came up among them"** - Rose among the ten horns (tribes of Europe)
2. **"Another" little horn** - Different from the ten
3. **Started small** ("little") - Began with little power
4. **Three horns plucked up by the roots** - Destroyed three of the ten tribes
5. **"Eyes like the eyes of man"** - Intelligence, shrewdness, human wisdom
6. **"Mouth speaking great things"** - Makes proud, blasphemous claims

This little horn is the most important part of Daniel 7—it represents a power that persecutes God's people and continues until Christ's return.

The Three Horns Plucked Up by the Roots

> **Daniel 7:8b** - "...before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots..."

Historical fulfillment: Three of the ten Germanic tribes were **destroyed** in the 5th-6th centuries:

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1. The Heruli (Destroyed 493 CE)

> **Daniel 7:8** - "...there came up among them another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots..."

Historical fact: Emperor Zeno (Eastern Roman Emperor) had commissioned **Theodoric the Ostrogoth** to march against the Heruli kingdom in Italy before Zeno's death in 491 CE. Theodoric completed this campaign in **493 CE**, destroying the Heruli kingdom under **Odoacer**.

Result: The Heruli kingdom was completely overthrown—"plucked up by the roots."

Why were they destroyed? The Heruli under Odoacer had resisted the bishop of Rome's growing claims to supreme authority. They were **Arian Christians** (who rejected the Trinitarian doctrine that Rome had made foundational to its authority).

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2. The Vandals (Destroyed 534 CE)

Historical fact: Emperor Justinian I (Eastern Roman Emperor) sent his general **Belisarius** to conquer the **Vandals** in North Africa.

Timeline:

- **533 CE** - Belisarius landed in North Africa
- **534 CE** - Vandals completely defeated and their kingdom destroyed

Why were they destroyed? The Vandals were also **Arian Christians** who opposed papal authority and Catholic doctrine.

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3. The Ostrogoths (Destroyed 538 CE)

Historical fact: After destroying the Vandals, Belisarius turned his attention to the **Ostrogoths** who controlled Rome itself.

Timeline:

- **536 CE** - Belisarius began siege of Rome
- **March 538 CE** - Belisarius drove the Ostrogoths out of Rome permanently

Why were they destroyed? The Ostrogoths were **Arian Christians** who had control over the city of Rome, preventing the bishop of Rome (pope) from exercising full power.

Significance of 538 CE: Once the Ostrogoths were removed from Rome, the papacy was free to exercise **supreme religious and political authority** in Western Europe. This date marks the beginning of **papal supremacy**—the 1,260 years of persecution prophesied in Daniel and Revelation.

Summary: Why Three Tribes Were Destroyed

All three tribes (Heruli, Vandals, Ostrogoths) shared one thing in common:

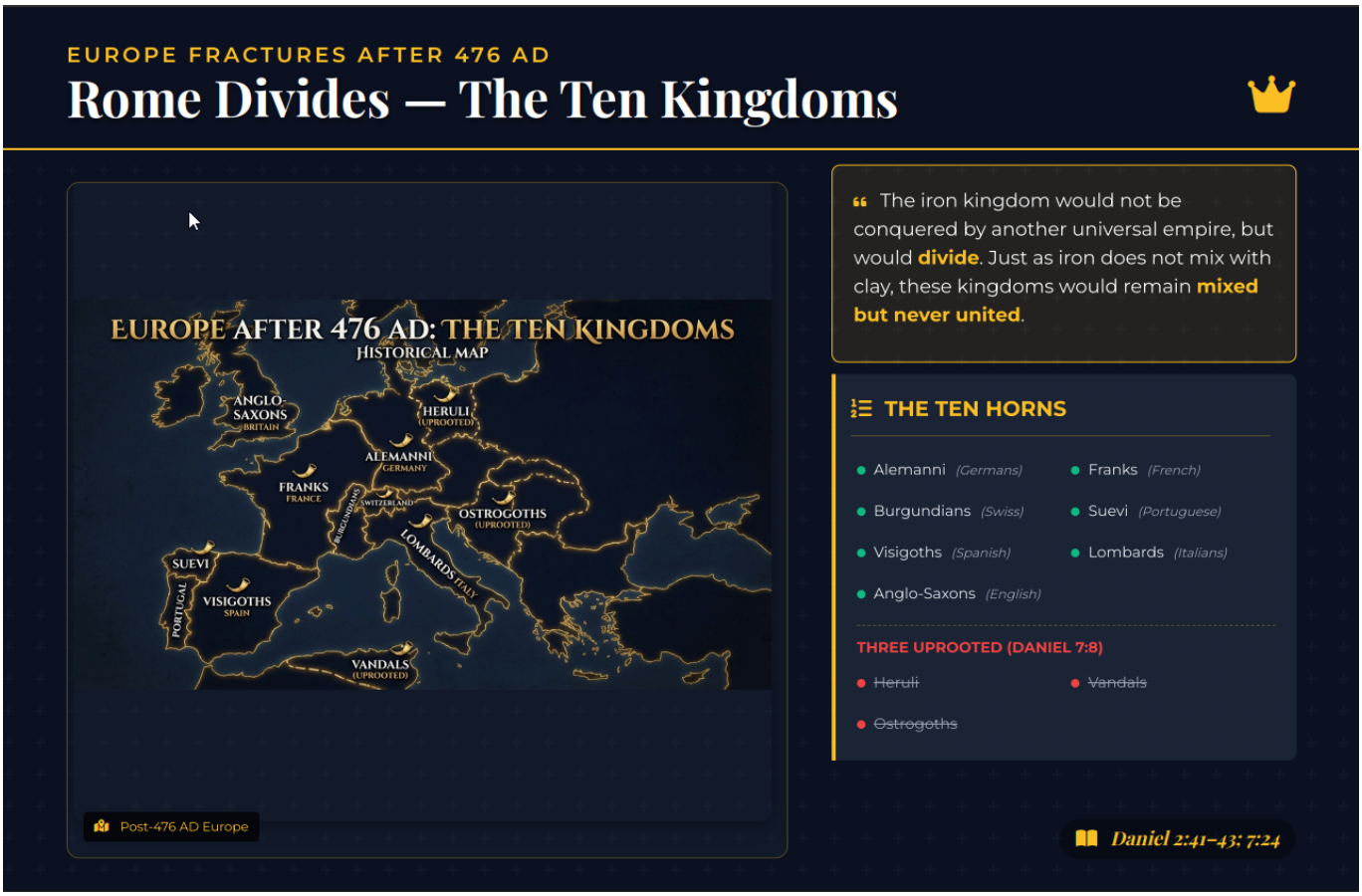
They opposed the papacy's doctrine and authority.

- They were **Arian Christians** (rejected Trinity doctrine)
- They opposed the bishop of Rome's claim to supreme authority
- They stood in the way of papal power

The Eastern Roman Empire (under Zeno and Justinian), **allied with the papacy**, systematically destroyed these three tribes to clear the way for **papal supremacy**.

"Plucked up by the roots" = Completely destroyed, never rose again

Exact fulfillment: Three horns destroyed, seven remained (France, England, Germany, Portugal, Spain, Italy, Switzerland)—exactly as prophesied.



Rome Divides - Ten Kingdoms

"Eyes Like the Eyes of Man"

> **Daniel 7:8c** - "...in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man..."

What do "eyes" represent in prophecy?

Eyes = intelligence, wisdom, understanding, observation

"Eyes like the eyes of man" = Human wisdom, cunning, shrewdness, political intelligence (as opposed to divine wisdom)

Application to the little horn (papacy):

- Claims to represent God but operates by **human wisdom** and **political cunning**
- Uses intelligence, strategy, diplomacy to gain and maintain power
- Watches ("eyes") over all kingdoms, gathering information, exerting influence
- **Human-centered authority** claiming divine right

Historical confirmation: The papacy became the most politically sophisticated institution in medieval Europe—using diplomacy, alliances, excommunication, interdicts, and manipulation to control kings and kingdoms.

"Mouth Speaking Great Things"

> **Daniel 7:8d** - "...and a mouth speaking great things."

What does the little horn speak?

We'll examine this in detail in the next section when we study Daniel's question about this power. But briefly:

"Great things" in Daniel's prophecy = **Blasphemous claims** (claiming authority that belongs to God alone)

Examples (which we'll explore in detail):

- Claims to be God on earth
- Claims authority to forgive sins
- Claims power to change God's law
- Claims supremacy over all earthly kings
- Claims infallibility (cannot err in doctrine)

This "mouth" is the defining characteristic of the little horn.

The Little Horn Makes War With the Saints

Daniel does not leave the little horn's characteristics vague—he also records what it *does*:

> **Daniel 7:21-22** - "I beheld, and the same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them; Until the Ancient of days came, and judgment was given to the saints of the most High; and the time came that the saints possessed the kingdom."

Three critical truths:

1. **"Made war with the saints"** — The little horn actively persecutes God's faithful people. This is not spiritual influence only—it is open warfare. History confirms this in the Inquisitions, the persecution of Waldensians, Albigensians, Huguenots, and all who refused to submit to Rome's authority.

2. **"Prevailed against them"** — The little horn was *winning* the earthly battle. The saints appeared to be losing. This matches Revelation 13:7: "And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them."

3. **"Until the Ancient of days came"** — God's judgment reverses the outcome. The saints are ultimately vindicated. The little horn does not win permanently.

The Time Prophecy: 1,260 Years

The angel gives Daniel further detail about the little horn's duration:

> **Daniel 7:25** - "And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time."

Four characteristics given here:

Characteristic	Meaning	Historical Fulfillment
"Speak great words against the Most High"	Blasphemy — claiming God's authority and titles	Papal titles: "Vicar of Christ," "Holy Father," claims to forgive sin

Characteristic	Meaning	Historical Fulfillment
"Wear out the saints"	Prolonged, grinding persecution	Centuries of Inquisitions, burning of reformers, forced conversions
"Think to change times and laws"	Attempts to alter God's commandments	Changed the Sabbath (4th commandment) from Saturday to Sunday; removed 2nd commandment
"Time, times, and dividing of time"	**3½ prophetic years = 1,260 days = 1,260 years**	538 CE (papal supremacy) to 1798 CE (Pope taken captive by Napoleon)

The Time Calculation:

- "Time" = 1 year = 360 days
- "Times" = 2 years = 720 days
- "Dividing of time" = ½ year = 180 days
- **Total = 1,260 days**

Applying the biblical **day-year principle** (Numbers 14:34, Ezekiel 4:6): **1,260 days = 1,260 years**

> **538 CE → 1798 CE = exactly 1,260 years**

538 CE: Ostrogoths expelled from Rome — papacy gains uncontested supremacy **1798 CE**: General Berthier, under Napoleon's orders, takes Pope Pius VI captive — the "deadly wound" of Revelation 13:3

This prophecy has been fulfilled with mathematical precision.

> **Daniel 7:26-27** - "But the judgment shall sit, and they shall take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it unto the end. And the kingdom and dominion, and the greatness of the kingdom under the whole heaven, shall be given to the people of the saints of the most High, whose kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey him."

The final outcome: The little horn's dominion is taken away and destroyed. God's eternal kingdom replaces it. The saints — those who remained faithful through the persecution — inherit the kingdom.

The Little Horn - A New Power Rises Among the Ten

The Little Horn's Change: God's Law vs. Rome's Revision

BIBLE COMMANDMENTS EXODUS 20: 2-17	**CATHOLIC COMMANDMENTS** CATECHISM OF THE CATHOLIC CHURCH[3]
1st Commandment 2 I am the Lord thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. 3 Thou shalt have no other gods before me.	**1st Catholic Commandment** I am the LORD your God: you shall not have strange gods before me.
2nd Commandment 4 Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth. 5 Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them: for I the Lord thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me; 6 And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments.	***2nd Commandment REMOVED & REPLACED with 3rd, and the rest re-numbered.*** **2nd Catholic Commandment** You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain.
3rd Commandment 7 Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain; for the Lord will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.	**3rd Catholic Commandment (verses missing)** Remember to keep holy the LORD's Day.
4th Commandment 8 Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. 9 Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work: 10 But the seventh day is the sabbath of the Lord thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates: 11 For in six days the Lord made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the Lord blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.	**4th Catholic Commandment** Honor your father and your mother.
5th Commandment 12 Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the Lord thy God giveth thee.	**5th Catholic Commandment** You shall not kill.
6th Commandment 13 Thou shalt not kill.	**6th Catholic Commandment** You shall not commit adultery.
7th Commandment 14 Thou shalt not commit adultery.	**7th Catholic Commandment** You shall not steal.
8th Commandment 15 Thou shalt not steal.	**8th Catholic Commandment** You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor.
9th Commandment 16 Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.	**9th Catholic Commandment(10th Commandment split in 2)** You shall not covet your neighbor's wife.
10th Commandment 17 Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.	**10th Catholic Commandment** You shall not covet your neighbor's goods.

"He shall intend to change times and law" (Daniel 7:25) — Comparing the original Ten Commandments with the Roman Catholic version

Part 8: Daniel's Question - Seeking Understanding

Daniel Was Troubled by the Vision

> **Daniel 7:15-16** - "I Daniel was grieved in my spirit in the midst of my body, and the visions of my head troubled me. I came near unto one of them that stood by, and asked him the truth of all this. So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things."

Daniel's response:

1. **Grieved in spirit** - The vision disturbed him deeply
2. **Troubled** - Couldn't understand it fully on his own
3. **Asked for truth** - Didn't rely on human interpretation; asked the heavenly being (angel)

Key principle: Daniel didn't speculate or guess—he asked God's messenger for the **true interpretation**.

Application: We should approach prophecy the same way—not with human theories, but seeking God's explanation through His Word.

The Angel's Interpretation

> **Daniel 7:17** - "These great beasts, which are four, are four kings, which shall arise out of the earth."

God's direct answer: The four beasts = **four kings** (kingdoms)

Note: "Kings" is often used interchangeably with "kingdoms" in prophecy (the king represents his kingdom).

> **Daniel 7:23** - "Thus he said, The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms, and shall devour the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces."

Further confirmation:

- Fourth beast = **fourth kingdom**
- Diverse from all kingdoms = **Rome's unique characteristics**
- Devour the whole earth = **Rome's universal conquest**

We now have divine confirmation: The beasts represent kingdoms, just as the metals in Daniel 2 represented kingdoms.

Part 9: The Judgment Scene - God's Courtroom

The Ancient of Days Sits in Judgment

> **Daniel 7:9-10** - "I beheld till the thrones were cast down, and the Ancient of days did sit, whose garment was white as snow, and the hair of His head like the pure wool: His throne was like the fiery flame, and His wheels as burning fire. A fiery stream issued and came forth from before Him: thousand thousands ministered unto Him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before Him: the judgment was set, and the books were opened."

The Heavenly Courtroom:

Who is present?

1. **"Ancient of days"** = God the Father (eternal, existed before time began)
2. **"Thousand thousands ministered unto Him"** = 1,000,000 angels serving
3. **"Ten thousand times ten thousand stood before Him"** = 100,000,000 angels as witnesses
4. **Thrones** (plural) = God and His divine council

What happens?

- **"Thrones were cast down"** = The Aramaic word (*remah*) is better rendered **"thrones were placed/set"**—judgment seats were arranged for the court. Many modern translations (NIV, ESV, NASB) render this as "thrones were set in place." The primary meaning is that the heavenly court convened, with thrones positioned for the divine council. The earthly thrones of beast kingdoms are **also** being brought into account before God's throne.
- **"The judgment was set"** = Court is in session
- **"The books were opened"** = Records of human lives examined

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Description of God:

- **"Garment white as snow"** = Perfect purity, righteousness
- **"Hair like pure wool"** = Wisdom, age, eternal nature (white hair = ancient)
- **"Throne like fiery flame"** = Holiness, judgment, glory
- **"Wheels as burning fire"** = Mobility, omnipresence, divine chariot

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The Beast Is Slain, Dominion Taken Away

Before the Son of Man receives His kingdom, Daniel records the fate of the beast powers:

> **Daniel 7:11-12** - "I beheld then because of the voice of the great words which the horn spake: I beheld even till the beast was slain, and his body destroyed, and given to the burning flame. As concerning the rest of the beasts, they had their dominion taken away: yet their lives were prolonged for a season and time."

Two important truths here:

1. **The fourth beast (Rome/little horn) is slain** — Its body is destroyed and cast into the burning flame. This pictures the final destruction of the little horn power at Christ's return (confirmed in **2 Thessalonians 2:8** — "whom the Lord shall consume with the spirit of His mouth, and shall destroy with the brightness of His coming").

2. **The other three beasts** (Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece) **had their dominion taken away, but their lives prolonged for a season** — While the empires fell militarily, the cultures, religions, and traditions of Babylon, Persia, and Greece were absorbed and continued in Rome and later in the little horn power. **The spirit of Babylon lives on** even though Babylon as a nation is gone. This is why Revelation calls the end-time apostasy **"Babylon"**—the same spirit in a new form.

The Son of Man Comes to the Ancient of Days

> **Daniel 7:13-14** - "I saw in the night visions, and, behold, one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven, and came to the Ancient of days, and they brought him near before him. And there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed."

Who is the "Son of man"?

Jesus Christ - He called Himself "Son of man" over 80 times in the Gospels.

What's happening here?

- Jesus (Son of man) approaches God the Father (Ancient of days)
- **This is not the Second Coming** (Jesus comes to the Father, not to earth)
- **This is the judgment scene in heaven** before the Second Coming
- Jesus receives His kingdom from the Father

The sequence:

1. Judgment takes place in heaven (Daniel 7:9-10)
2. Jesus approaches the Father (Daniel 7:13)
3. Jesus receives His kingdom (Daniel 7:14)
4. Jesus returns to earth as King (Revelation 19:11-16)

The Kingdom Given to Christ:

- **"Dominion, and glory, and a kingdom"** = Complete authority to rule
- **"All people, nations, and languages should serve Him"** = Universal kingdom
- **"Everlasting dominion"** = Never ends (unlike Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, Rome)
- **"Shall not be destroyed"** = Eternal, indestructible kingdom

This is the same kingdom represented by the "stone cut without hands" in Daniel 2!

When Does This Judgment Occur?

Timing clues:

1. **After the little horn's reign** - The judgment occurs after the little horn (papacy) has exercised power (Daniel 7:8-12)
2. **Before the Second Coming** - Jesus receives the kingdom from the Father in heaven, **then** returns to earth
3. **"Time of the end"** - Daniel and Revelation both indicate this judgment occurs in the final period of earth's history

This is called the "investigative judgment" or "pre-advent judgment":

- Occurs in heaven before Jesus returns
- Determines who will be saved and who will be lost

- Records ("books") are examined
- Once judgment is complete, Jesus returns to execute the verdict

For a detailed study of this judgment, see Daniel 8:14, 9:24-27, and Revelation 14:6-7 (the three angels' messages).

Part 10: Comparing the Beasts to Human History

A Different Perspective on the Same Kingdoms

Why does God show the same kingdoms twice?

Daniel 2 (human perspective):

- Glorious image
- Precious metals (gold, silver, bronze)
- Impressive, beautiful, awe-inspiring
- **How man views human kingdoms**

Daniel 7 (God's perspective):

- Savage beasts
- Devouring, destroying, stamping
- Terrifying, brutal, bloodthirsty
- **How God views human kingdoms**

The lesson: What humans admire (powerful empires, military conquest, human glory), **God sees as beastly and destructive**.

God's View of Human Kingdoms

> **Hosea 13:6-9** - "According to their pasture, so were they filled; they were filled, and their heart was exalted; therefore have they forgotten Me. Therefore I will be unto them as a lion: as a leopard by the way will I observe them: I will meet them as a bear that is bereaved of her whelps, and will rend the caul of their heart, and there will I devour them like a lion: the wild beast shall tear them. O Israel, thou hast destroyed thyself; but in Me is thine help."

Key points:

1. **"Their heart was exalted"** = Pride in their own power and glory
2. **"Therefore have they forgotten Me"** = Human pride leads to forgetting God
3. **God compares Himself to these beasts** (lion, leopard, bear) when He brings judgment
4. **"O Israel, thou hast destroyed thyself"** = Human kingdoms destroy themselves through sin and pride

Application: The same beasts Daniel saw (lion, bear, leopard) represent both:

- The kingdoms themselves (Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece)
- God's judgment upon those kingdoms for pride and oppression

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The Ultimate Kingdom: Not Beastly, But Divine

Human kingdoms: Babylon → Medo-Persia → Greece → Rome → Divided Europe

- All beastly
- All temporary
- All destroyed

God's kingdom: The stone, the Son of man, the everlasting dominion

- Divine origin
- Eternal duration
- Universal scope
- **Not beastly, but righteous**

The contrast is clear: Choose to belong to human kingdoms (beastly, temporary, judged) or God's kingdom (divine, eternal, glorious).

Part 11: God Controls History

The Sovereignty of God

> **Daniel 2:21** - "And He changeth the times and the seasons: He removeth kings, and setteth up kings: He giveth wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to them that know understanding"

Key truths:

1. **"He changeth the times and the seasons"** = God controls the flow of history
2. **"He removeth kings, and setteth up kings"** = No human rules without God's permission
3. **God gives wisdom and knowledge** = Understanding prophecy comes from God, not human scholarship

Application: The rise and fall of Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, and Rome were not accidents—**God ordained the succession of kingdoms**.

God Named the Conquerors Before They Were Born

Example: Cyrus of Persia

> **Isaiah 44:24-28** - "Thus saith the LORD, thy redeemer, and he that formed thee from the womb, I am the LORD that maketh all things; that stretcheth forth the heavens alone; that spreadeth abroad the earth by Myself; That frustrateth the tokens of the liars, and maketh diviners mad; that turneth wise men backward, and maketh their knowledge foolish; That confirmeth the word of His servant, and performeth the counsel of His messengers; that saith to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be inhabited; and to the cities of Judah, Ye shall be built, and I will raise up the decayed places thereof: That saith to the deep, Be dry, and I will dry up thy rivers: **That saith of Cyrus, He is my shepherd, and shall perform all my pleasure: even saying to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be built; and to the temple, Thy foundation shall be laid.**"

Mind-blowing fact: Isaiah wrote this prophecy around **700 BCE**, naming **Cyrus** by name **150 years before he was born**.

What God predicted:

1. Cyrus would be God's "shepherd" (chosen instrument)
2. Cyrus would conquer Babylon
3. Cyrus would allow the Jews to return to Jerusalem
4. Cyrus would decree the temple be rebuilt

Historical fulfillment:

- Cyrus conquered Babylon in 539 BCE (exactly as prophesied)
- Cyrus issued a decree allowing Jews to return (Ezra 1:1-4)
- Cyrus funded the rebuilding of the temple (Ezra 6:3-5)

Conclusion: If God could name a king 150 years before his birth and predict exactly what he would do, **we can trust every detail of Daniel's prophecy**.

Human Plans vs. God's Plans

Humans plan: Build empires, gain power, establish eternal kingdoms

God says: I remove kings and set up kings. Your kingdoms will fall. Only My kingdom endures.

The lesson: Don't put your trust in human governments, human power, human glory. They're all temporary. **Trust in God's eternal kingdom.**

Part 12: The Ultimate Question - Which Kingdom Will You Choose?

Two Kingdoms, Two Destinies

The Beast Kingdoms (Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, Rome, Little Horn):

- Rise through conquest and bloodshed
- Oppress and persecute God's people
- Appear glorious but are beastly
- Temporary and doomed to destruction
- Judged and condemned by God

God's Kingdom (The Son of Man's Everlasting Dominion):

- Established by divine appointment
- Delivers and saves God's people
- Appears humble but is glorious
- Eternal and indestructible
- Righteous and just forever

The choice: Which kingdom will you belong to?

The Most Important Truth

> **1 Corinthians 13:2** - "And though I have the gift of prophecy, and understand all mysteries and all knowledge, and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, but have not love, I am nothing"

Warning: You can understand every detail of Daniel 7:

- Identify all four beasts correctly
- Know the dates of every kingdom
- Recognize the little horn
- Explain the judgment scene

But if you don't have love for God and others, it means nothing.

Prophecy is not just about knowledge—it's about relationship.

The purpose of prophecy:

1. **Builds faith** - When we see prophecy fulfilled, we trust God's Word
2. **Warns of danger** - The little horn persecutes; we must be prepared
3. **Gives hope** - God's kingdom is coming; evil will not triumph forever
4. **Calls to decision** - Choose God's kingdom today while there's still time

But above all, prophecy reveals **God's love**:

- He warned us ahead of time
- He showed us the enemy (little horn)
- He promised deliverance (judgment in our favor)
- He guaranteed victory (everlasting kingdom)

This is love.

The Final Appeal

You've now seen:

- Four kingdoms revealed (lion, bear, leopard, terrible beast)
- Historical fulfillment spanning 2,500+ years
- The little horn identified (coming up among the ten horns, destroying three, speaking great things)
- The judgment scene in heaven (God's courtroom determining human destiny)
- The promise of Christ's eternal kingdom

The question: Will you be part of the beast kingdoms or God's kingdom?

> **Revelation 13:8** - "And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him [the beast], whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world."

Two groups:

1. **Those who worship the beast** - Names not in the Book of Life
2. **Those who follow the Lamb** - Names written in the Book of Life

Choose today: The books are open (Daniel 7:10). The judgment is underway. Your name is either in the Book of Life or it's not.

What will you choose?

Part 13: Study Summary and Review

The Four Beasts Identified

Beast #1: LION with eagle's wings = **BABYLON** (605-539 BCE)

- Biblical proof: Jeremiah 4:7, 50:17
- Characteristics: Swift conquest, wings plucked (decline), became weak
- Parallel to Daniel 2: Head of gold

Beast #2: BEAR raised on one side, three ribs = **MEDO-PERSIA** (539-331 BCE)

- Biblical proof: Daniel 8:20
- Characteristics: Lopsided (Persia stronger than Media), three conquests (Lydia, Babylon, Egypt)
- Parallel to Daniel 2: Chest and arms of silver

Beast #3: LEOPARD with four wings, four heads = **GREECE** (331-168 BCE)

- Biblical proof: Daniel 8:21-22
- Characteristics: Extreme speed (four wings = Alexander's rapid conquest), four divisions (generals after Alexander)
- Parallel to Daniel 2: Belly and thighs of bronze

Beast #4: DREADFUL BEAST with iron teeth, ten horns = **ROME** (168 BCE - 476 CE, then continuing)

- Biblical proof: Daniel 2:40 (iron kingdom), historical succession
- Characteristics: Most powerful, diverse from all others, divided into ten tribes
- Parallel to Daniel 2: Legs of iron, feet of iron and clay

Little Horn: Rises among ten, destroys three, speaks great things = **PAPAL ROME** (538 CE – 1798 CE supreme dominion; continues today in healing wound phase)

- Destroyed three Arian tribes (Heruli 493, Vandals 534, Ostrogoths 538)
- Eyes like a man (human wisdom), mouth speaking great things (blasphemy — Daniel 7:8, 20, 25)
- **Makes war with the saints** (Daniel 7:21) — confirmed by 1,260 years of persecution
- **"Time, times, and dividing of time"** = 1,260 year reign of supremacy: 538 CE → 1798 CE (Daniel 7:25)
- **"Think to change times and laws"** = Changed Sabbath from Saturday to Sunday; altered the Ten Commandments
- *(See the companion guide on Daniel 8 for even greater detail on this power)*

Key Symbols Decoded

Sea = Peoples, nations, multitudes (Revelation 17:15, Isaiah 57:20)

Winds = War, strife, conquest (Jeremiah 49:36-37, 4:5-7)

Beasts = Kingdoms/kings (Daniel 7:17, 23)

Horns = Kings/kingdoms (Daniel 7:24, 8:20)

Ancient of Days = God the Father (Daniel 7:9)

Son of Man = Jesus Christ (Daniel 7:13-14)

Judgment scene = Pre-advent judgment in heaven (Daniel 7:9-10)

Timeline Summary

603 BCE - Daniel 2: Nebuchadnezzar's dream (image prophecy)
553 BCE - Daniel 7: Daniel's vision (beasts prophecy)
539 BCE - Babylon falls to Medo-Persia
331 BCE - Medo-Persia falls to Greece
323 BCE - Alexander dies, Greece divides into four
168 BCE - Rome conquers Greece
476 CE - Western Rome falls, divides into ten tribes
493 CE - Heruli destroyed (first horn plucked up)
534 CE - Vandals destroyed (second horn plucked up)
538 CE - Ostrogoths driven from Rome — **papal supremacy begins** (third horn plucked up); **1,260-year prophecy begins**
1798 CE - Pope Pius VI taken captive by Napoleon — **papal supremacy interrupted**; 1,260-year prophecy ends (Daniel 7:25)
1844 CE - End of the 2,300 days of Daniel 8:14 — **heavenly judgment (investigative judgment) begins**
PRESENT - We are living in the time after the deadly wound is healed (Revelation 13:3); judgment continues in heaven
FUTURE - Judgment completed in heaven, Christ receives kingdom from the Father, Second Coming, saints inherit the eternal kingdom

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Appendix: Study Questions for Personal Reflection

Part 1: Vision Basics

1. When did Daniel receive this vision? (Daniel 7:1)
2. What do "waters" or "sea" represent in biblical prophecy? (Revelation 17:15)
3. What do "winds" represent? (Jeremiah 49:36-37)
4. What do "beasts" represent? (Daniel 7:17, 23)

Part 2: The Four Beasts

5. What kingdom does the lion represent? Prove it from Scripture. (Jeremiah 4:7, 50:17)
6. What do the eagle's wings represent? (Jeremiah 4:13, Deuteronomy 28:49)
7. What happened to the lion's wings? What does this mean historically?

8. What kingdom does the bear represent? Prove it from Scripture. (Daniel 8:20)
9. Why was the bear "raised up on one side"? (Daniel 8:3-4)
10. What do the three ribs represent? (Daniel 8:4)
11. What kingdom does the leopard represent? Prove it from Scripture. (Daniel 8:21)
12. Why does the leopard have four wings (instead of two like the lion)?
13. What do the four heads represent? (Daniel 8:22)
14. What kingdom does the terrible beast represent? How do you know?
15. Why is the fourth beast "diverse from all the beasts"?

Part 3: The Ten Horns

16. What do "horns" represent in prophecy? (Daniel 7:24)
17. What are the ten horns of the fourth beast? (List them if possible)
18. How many of these ten divisions still exist today as nations?

Part 4: The Little Horn

19. Where does the little horn arise from? (Daniel 7:8)
20. How many horns were "plucked up by the roots"? Which ones?
21. What do the "eyes like a man" represent?
22. What does the "mouth speaking great things" represent?
23. What does the little horn do to the saints, and how long does it prevail against them? (Daniel 7:21-22)
24. What does "think to change times and laws" mean? What historical evidence supports this? (Daniel 7:25)
25. What is "a time, times, and the dividing of time"? How long is it, and what years does it cover? Calculate it step by step. (Daniel 7:25)

Part 5: The Judgment

26. Who is the "Ancient of days"? (Daniel 7:9)
27. Who is the "Son of man"? (Daniel 7:13)
28. Where does this judgment take place—in heaven or on earth?
29. What happens in this judgment? (Daniel 7:10)
30. When does Jesus receive His kingdom? (Daniel 7:14)

Part 6: Application

31. How does God view human kingdoms (compared to how humans view them)?
32. What does Daniel 7 teach us about God's control over history?
33. Which kingdom will you choose—the beast kingdoms or God's eternal kingdom?

Additional Resources for Further Study

Recommended Bible Study Topics:

1. **Daniel 2** - The image prophecy (parallel to Daniel 7)
2. **Daniel 8** - Ram and goat (focuses on Medo-Persia and Greece, introduces the little horn in more detail)
3. **Daniel 9** - The seventy weeks (timing prophecy related to Messiah and the little horn)

4. **Daniel 12** - Time prophecies and final deliverance
5. **Revelation 13** - The beast from the sea (parallel to Daniel 7's little horn)
6. **Revelation 17** - The whore riding the beast (Babylon and the beast power together)

Conclusion: The Certainty of God's Prophecy

Four Kingdoms Fulfilled = Complete Accuracy

Daniel's prophecy in chapter 7 has been fulfilled with stunning precision:

✓ **Lion** (Babylon) = Conquered by Medo-Persia in 539 BCE
✓ **Bear** (Medo-Persia) = Conquered by Greece in 331 BCE
✓ **Leopard** (Greece) = Conquered by Rome in 168 BCE
✓ **Terrible Beast** (Rome) = Fell and divided in 476 CE
✓ **Ten Horns** = Exactly ten tribes divided Rome
✓ **Three Horns Destroyed** = Heruli (493), Vandals (534), Ostrogoths (538)

Every detail fulfilled exactly as predicted over 2,500 years ago.

The Remaining Prophecy Will Be Fulfilled

What remains?

1. The judgment scene (currently underway in heaven)
2. The little horn's final persecution
3. Christ receiving His kingdom from the Father
4. The Second Coming and establishment of God's eternal kingdom

If Daniel was 100% accurate about the past, we can trust with absolute certainty that the remaining prophecies will be fulfilled.

The Call to Decision

> **Joshua 24:15** - "...choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD."

The time to choose is now:

- The judgment is underway (Daniel 7:10)
- The books are opened
- Your name is being examined
- Your choices matter

Will you serve the beast kingdoms or the Kingdom of God?

The choice is yours. Choose wisely. Choose today.

The Promise

> **Daniel 7:27** - "And the kingdom and dominion, and the greatness of the kingdom under the whole heaven, shall be given to the people of the saints of the most High, whose kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey Him."

God's promise to His faithful people:

- We will receive the kingdom
- It will last forever
- All nations will serve God
- Victory is guaranteed

Hold on. Stay faithful. The King is coming.

"*Even so, come, Lord Jesus!*" (Revelation 22:20)

Document Information:

- **Title**: Daniel 7 & 8: The Kingdoms Revealed — A Complete Bible Study Guide
- **Companion Guide**: Daniel 8 (deeper study) — The Ram, Goat, 2,300 Days, and the Little Horn Expanded

- **Enhanced and Expanded**: February 2026
- **Authority**: Bible and Bible Alone (Sola Scriptura)
- **Method**: Comparing spiritual things with spiritual (1 Corinthians 2:13)

All glory to God alone.